Prime Mover

BECAUSE the 1972-batch Gujarat cadre IAS officer is the most powerful bureaucrat and continues to be the most-trusted aide of PM Narendra Modi. From anchoring key reforms and government appointments to implementing key policies, Mishra remains indispensable to the establishment

BECAUSE he is the final filter, before matters reach the PM, for the appointment of bureaucrats, technocrats and, also, politicians in crucial positions. His opinion even matters for appointments in the states. His decentralised style of functioning helps him create a talent pool of bureaucrats

SELF-EFFACING
Those who have worked with him say despite his power and influence, he stays low-key

CALAMITY CAPTAIN
An expert in disaster management, he received a UN award in 2003 as the CEO of the Gujarat State Disaster Management Authority for its handling of the 2001 Bhuj earthquake

BECAUSE he paved the way for the implementation of one of the Modi regime's biggest reforms, which entailed consideration of merit-cum-seniority, or the best person for the best job in appointments, with a resolve to remove bureaucratic deadwood, and capacity-building of the babus



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

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GOVERNOR, RESERVE BANK OF INDIA

MONEY MANAGER

BECAUSE he has steered the central bank through two major crises—the Covid-19 pandemic and the Ukraine war—battling inflation and a falling rupee in the aftermath of the war that pushed many large economies to the brink of a recession

BECAUSE the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee has reined in runaway inflation after it steadily raised rates since May 2021 to keep inflation closer to the upper range of 6 per cent of the target band

BECAUSE his is a voice of reassurance, with India's banking sector remaining resilient through tough times. RBI's stress tests show that Indian banks will be able to maintain their capital buffers above the minimum requirements even in the midst of distressing events

DIGITAL DRIVE **The RBI launched a pilot project of its digital currency, the e-Rupee, last December, in Mumbai, New Delhi, Bengaluru and Bhubaneswar**

EDUCATIONAL HISTORY
Das has an MA in History from Delhi University, and later pursued a financial management course at IIM Bangalore

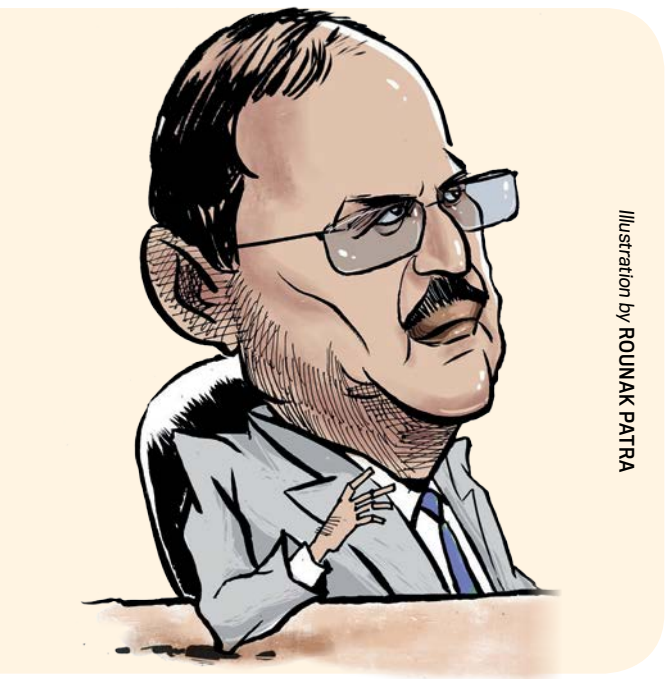


Illustration by ROUNAK PATRA